

IVAN KURILLA**Visiting Professor of History, The Ohio State University**

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RESEARCH AREAS

International history and foreign policy; U.S.-Russian relations; U.S. foreign relations; political identity and foreign policy; historical memory and politics of history; international dimensions of the American Civil War.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Visiting Professor of History, The Ohio State University	2025–2027
Professor of History, Summer Russian Language School, Middlebury College	2025, 2026
International Scholar in Residence, Wellesley College	2025
Visiting Tallman Scholar in Russian, East European, and Eurasian Studies, Bowdoin College	2024
Mary L. Cornille Distinguished Visiting Professor in the Humanities, Wellesley College	2024
Professor, European University at St. Petersburg	2015–2024
Professor, Smolny Faculty of Liberal Arts and Sciences, St. Petersburg State University	2015
Visiting Scholar, IERES, George Washington University	2012–2013
Professor, Volgograd State University	2006–2015
Associate Professor / Professor, Volgograd State University	1995–2006
Research Fellow, Institute of Universal History, Russian Academy of Sciences	2004–2005
Fulbright Visiting Scholar, Department of History, Dartmouth College	2001–2002
Research Fellow, Department of Modern and Contemporary History, Moscow State University	1994
Assistant Professor, Volgograd State University	1991–1995

EDUCATION

Doktor Nauk (Habilitation), History, Institute of Universal History, Russian Academy of Sciences	2005
Kandidat Nauk (PhD equivalent), History, Institute of Universal History, Russian Academy of Sciences	1996
Diploma with Honors (MA level), History, Volgograd State University	1991

CURRENT RESEARCH

- *Russia and the American Civil War*. Russian-language manuscript completed in 2026; revision and expansion for an English-language edition in preparation. The project examines the political translation of American debates over emancipation, federalism, nationality, democracy, and international order in nineteenth-century Russia.
- *Historical Narratives, National Identity, and Russian Foreign Policy* (working title). New book project on the relationship among changing interpretations of the past, conceptions of Russia's place in the international order, and foreign-policy choices from the late Soviet period to the present.
- *Routledge Handbook of Contemporary Russian History*. Co-editor with Vladimir Gel'man and Sari Autio-Sarasma; under contract with Routledge; project scheduled for completion in 2027.

BOOKS AND EDITED VOLUMES***English-language books and edited volumes***

Distant Friends and Intimate Enemies: A History of American–Russian Relations. With David S. Foglesong and Victoria I. Zhuravleva. Cambridge University Press, 2025.

Americans and All the Rest: Identity and Foreign Policy in U.S. History. Palgrave Macmillan, 2026. English edition of the 2024 Prosvetitel Prize-winning Russian original.

Battle for the Past: How Politics Rewrites History. Palgrave Macmillan, 2025.

Echoes of the American Civil War Abroad: Perceptions, Identities, and Historical Memory. Co-edited with Victoria I. Zhuravleva. Bloomsbury Academic, forthcoming September 2026.

Trailing the Bolsheviks: Twelve Thousand Miles with the Allies in Siberia, by Carl W. Ackerman. Edited and annotated. Slavica, 2020; new edition, Anthem Press, 2025.

Russian/Soviet Studies in the United States, Amerikanistika in Russia: Mutual Representations in Academic Projects. Co-edited with Victoria I. Zhuravleva. Lexington Books, 2016.

Books and edited volumes in Russian

Amerikantsy i vse ostalnye: Istoki i smysl vneshnei politiki SShA [Americans and All the Rest: Origins and Meaning of U.S. Foreign Policy]. Alpina, 2024. **2024 Prosvetitel Prize** (best nonfiction book in Russian).

Bitva za proshloe: Kak politika meniaet istoriiu [Battle for the Past: How Politics Changes History]. Alpina, 2022. Politprosvet Prize shortlist, 2022.

Zakliatye družia: Istoriia mnenii, fantazii, kontaktov, vzaimo(ne)ponimaniia Rossii i SShA [Frenemies: A History of Opinions, Fantasies, Contacts, and Mutual (Mis)understanding between Russia and the United States]. NLO, 2018. Prosvetitel Prize longlist, 2018.

Istoriia, ili proshloe v nastoiashchem [History, or the Past in the Present]. European University at St. Petersburg Press, 2017. Prosvetitel Prize shortlist, 2017.

Zaokeanskie partnery: Amerika i Rossiia v 1830–1850-e gody [Overseas Partners: America and Russia in the 1830s–1850s]. Volgograd University Press, 2005.

“Voiti v krug velikikh derzhav...”: *Daniel Webster i vneshniaia politika SShA v seredine XIX veka* [“Enter the Circle” of Great Powers: Daniel Webster and U.S. Foreign Policy in the Mid-Nineteenth Century]. Volgograd University Press, 1997.

Rossiia dvukhtysiachnykh: stereoskopicheskii vzgliad [Russia in the 2000s: A Stereoscopic View]. Co-edited with Henry E. Hale. Planeta, 2011.

Rossiia i SShA na stranitsakh uchebnikov: opyt vzaimnykh reprezentatsii [Russia and the U.S. in Textbooks: Mutual Representations]. Co-edited with Victoria I. Zhuravleva. Volgograd University Press, 2009.

SELECTED SCHOLARLY ARTICLES AND CHAPTERS

“The Distant War, the Near Debate: Russian Identity Discourses and the U.S. Civil War.” In *Echoes of the American Civil War Abroad: Perceptions, Identities, and Historical Memory*. Bloomsbury Academic, forthcoming 2026.

“History as a Political Language.” In *Education and the Politics of Memory in Russia and Eastern Europe: Infested with History*. Routledge, 2025.

“Understanding the Immortal Regiment: Memory Dualism in a Social Movement.” *Europe-Asia Studies* 75, no. 8 (2023): 1266–1285.

“Evaluating the Demise of the Soviet Union.” With Archie Brown, Thomas W. Simons, Andrea Graziosi, Louis D. Sell, and Vladislav Zubok. *Journal of Cold War Studies* 25, no. 3 (2023): 142–187.

“Russia and the US in the Mirrors of Academic Research.” *Arei: Journal for Central and Eastern European History and Politics* 1, no. 1 (2022): 68–91.

“Presentism, Politicization of History, and the New Role of the Historian in Russia.” In *The Future of the Soviet Past: The Politics of History in Putin’s Russia*. Indiana University Press, 2021, 29–47.

“Debates about Russia, America, and New World Order: Four Books from the 1850s.” *Vestnik Volgogradskogo gosudarstvennogo universiteta* 26, no. 5 (2021): 225–231.

“Reusing Soviet History Books: The Role of World War II in Russian Domestic Politics and Academia.” *The Journal of Slavic Military Studies* 33, no. 4 (2020): 502–507.

“George Frost Kennan and Russian-American Relations.” In *A Kennan for Our Times: Revisiting America’s Greatest 20th Century Diplomat in the 21st Century*. Wilson Center, Kennan Institute, 2019, 151–163.

“Russia, Trump, and the United States: The Uses of the Other in a Political Crisis.” In *The New World Disorder: Challenges and Threats in an Uncertain World*. Lexington Books, 2019, 129–136.

“Russia’s View on Obama’s Presidency: From Hope to Disappointment.” With Victoria I. Zhuravleva. In *The World Views of the Obama Era: From Hope to Disillusionment*. Palgrave Macmillan, 2018, 113–139.

“How Home Agenda Defines the Study of the Other: Russia and the US in the 1850s.” In *Russian/Soviet Studies in the United States, Amerikanistika in Russia*. Lexington Books, 2016.

Complete publication list: kurilla.site/publications

SELECTED POLICY PUBLICATIONS

“Do Russians Support the War? How the Answer Reflects Biases, Uncertainty, and Old Divisions.” PONARS Eurasia Policy Memo, November 2022.

“Nationalizing Russian (War) Memory Since 2014.” PONARS Eurasia Policy Memo, July 2020.

“Toward the Possibility of a New U.S.–Russian ‘Reset’: Does Their Hot & Cold Past Foretell Their Future?” PONARS Eurasia Policy Memo, May 2019.

“The Anti-Russia Surge in U.S. Politics: Finding Context.” PONARS Eurasia Policy Memo, April 2018.

“History and Memory in Russia During the 100-Year Anniversary of the Great Revolution.” PONARS Eurasia Policy Memo, January 2018.

“The ‘Return of Stalin’: Understanding the Surge of Historical Politics in Russia.” PONARS Eurasia Policy Memo, May 2016.

“The Implications of Russia’s Law against the ‘Rehabilitation of Nazism.’” PONARS Eurasia Policy Memo, August 2014.

SELECTED PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

2026: “Russian Neutrality in the American Revolution: Fear, Strategy, and Opportunity,” video podcast interview for *Analyzing American Revolution*.

2026: Online discussion with David S. Foglesong on *Distant Friends and Intimate Enemies* and the history of U.S.-Russian relations, East-West Connections.

2025: Kennan Institute, Wilson Center, book conversation on *Distant Friends and Intimate Enemies*.

2024: “Shameful Questions About America / Стыдные вопросы про Америку,” long-form interview with journalist Yuri Dud on U.S. history, American identity, and U.S.-Russian relations; more than 5 million views on YouTube.

2024: Cornille Lecture, Wellesley College: “Political Use and Misuse of the Past in Russia, America, and Elsewhere.”

2024: Wellesley College / Harvard Davis Center: “What the Russian People Think About the War and Its Mastermind.”

2024: Voice of America Russian, long-form discussion of the U.S. election, Russia, Ukraine, and China.

2019: Claremont McKenna College: “Can Russian-American Relations Be Fixed? Lessons from History.”

Op-eds: *The Washington Post*, *The National Interest*, *The Moscow Times*, *Al Jazeera*, *Russia Matters*, *The Conversation*, and other outlets; **expert commentary:** *The New York Times*, BBC, NPR, Voice of America, Sky News, and others.

TEACHING AND ADVISING

The Ohio State University (2025–2027): *Civil War and Reconstruction: Global Perspectives*; *History of U.S.-Russian Relations*; *Uses and Misuses of History: History, Memory, and Politics in the Contemporary World*.

Middlebury College Summer Russian Language School (2025–2026): *Foreign Policy of Post-Soviet Russia, 1992–2026*; *World War II and Global Memory*; *History of Russian-American Relations*.

Wellesley College (2024–2025): *How Distant Friends Became Intimate Enemies: Russian-American Relations in Past and Present*.

Bowdoin College (2024): *Frenemies: History of Russian-American Relations*.

European University at St. Petersburg (2015–2024): *History of U.S.-Russian Relations from a Constructivist Perspective* (MA); *Historical Memory and Politics of History*; *History and Politics*; *Introduction to American Studies*.

Volgograd State University (1991–2015): U.S. History; Modern History of Europe and America; History of Historical Knowledge; Introduction to Russian History for U.S. exchange students.

Graduate advising: MA theses in Russian and English and Kandidatskaya dissertations (PhD equivalent) on U.S. history, U.S.-Russian relations, historical memory, nationalism, and the political uses of the past.

ACADEMIC AND PROGRAM LEADERSHIP

Academic Director, International MA Program (IMARES), European University at St. Petersburg	2016–2022
Director, Program of Regional Cooperation, European University at St. Petersburg	2015–2022
Head, Center for North American Studies Americana, Volgograd State University	2008–2015
Head, Department of International Relations and Area Studies, Volgograd State University	2006–2015
Vice Rector for International Programs, Volgograd State University	2002–2003
Deputy Dean, Department of History and Philosophy, Volgograd State University	1995–1998

EDITORIAL AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

International Advisory Board, Post-Soviet Space Research Initiative, University of Melbourne	2025–present
Editorial Board, <i>REGION: Regional Studies of Russia, Eastern Europe, and Central Asia</i>	2020–present
Editorial Board, <i>The Journal of Russian American Studies</i>	2017–present
Editorial Board, <i>Amerikanskii Ezhegodnik</i> (American Yearbook, Russian Academy of Sciences)	2008–2025
Editor-in-Chief, <i>Vestnik Volgogradskogo Universiteta</i> , Series 4;	2015–2024
Editor-in-Chief, <i>Americana</i> ;	2008–2021
PONARS Eurasia, member since 1999; Executive Committee	2003–2005
Kennan Institute Russian Alumni Association, Head of Council	2008–2015
Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies (ASEEES), member	2012–present
Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR), member	

SELECTED CONFERENCES ORGANIZED

Americans in Revolutionary Petrograd, international conference, St. Petersburg; chair	2017
Russia and the American Civil War, conference, Volgograd; chair	2011
Russian/Soviet Studies in the United States, American Studies in Russia: Mutual Representations, international conference, Moscow; co-chair with Victoria I. Zhuravleva	2011
Concept of Human Security in Canada and Russia, international conference; chair	2009
Russia and Countries of the American Continent: The Experience of Historical Relationships, international conference; chair	2007

SELECTED AWARDS AND HONORS

Prosvetitel Prize (Humanities), for <i>Amerikantsy i vse ostalnye</i> ,	2024
Politprosvet Prize, shortlist, for <i>Bitva za proshloe</i>	2022
Prosvetitel Prize, shortlist, for <i>Istoriia, ili proshloe v nastoiashchem</i>	2017
Fulbright Visiting Scholar, Dartmouth College	2001–2002

LANGUAGES: **Russian:** Native. **English:** Fluent.